
Keep on “Liking” us: The *JAAD*’s Facebook page turns 2 years old

Chante Karimkhani, BA,^a Ryan Gamble, MD,^b and Robert P. Dellavalle, MD, PhD, MSPH^{b,c,d}
New York, New York; and Aurora and Denver, Colorado

Key words: dermatology; Facebook; *Journal of the American Academy of Dermatology*; social media.

Facebook dominates online social networks with more than 1 billion users as of March 2013, a greater than 1000% increase from the site’s 100 million users in 2008.¹ Facebook has approximately 700 million daily active users making it the second most visited World Wide Web site after Google.^{2,3} Nineteen percent of US adults saw news or news headlines on a social network “yesterday,” a 211% increase from 2010. In the 18- to 24-year-old population, this percentage is even higher at 34%.⁴ The increasing popularity of social media accompanies a rise of digital advertising and mobile use coincident with a decline in traditional newsroom reporting, newspapers, and local TV viewership.⁴ A striking 59% of US adults have searched online for health information in the past year and 1 in 3 US adults turned to the Internet to aid them in specific medical condition diagnosis, with 77% of these starting at a general search engine such as Google and a smaller number starting with specific health information World Wide Web sites (13%) or social media (1%).⁵ Amidst this digital revolution, the *Journal of the American Academy of Dermatology* (*JAAD*) officially joined Facebook on May 31, 2011. On August 13, 2013, *JAAD* was the second most “Liked” dermatology journal on Facebook with 4905 “Likes.”⁶

On August 13, 2013, *JAAD* analytical statistics were collected by a senior medical student (C. K.). Using Facebook’s insight section, information on the demographics of users who “Liked” the *JAAD*’s page was analyzed. These data were also used to determine the top-5 posts in each of 3 categories: reach, engaged users, and talked about. All post data were analyzed from December 22, 2012, to August 13,

Table I. Demographics of users who “Liked” *JAAD*’s Facebook page

Gender	
Male	34%
Female	65%
Age, y	
13-17	0.4%
18-24	12%
25-34	51%
35-44	22%
45-54	9%
55-64	3%
≥ 65	1.4%
Top-5 countries of origin	
United States	18%
Brazil	17%
Egypt	14%
India	4%
Mexico	3%
Top-5 languages spoken	
English	58%
Portuguese	16%
Spanish	7%
Arabic	6%
French	2%

2013.⁶ “Reach” refers to the number of people who have seen a particular post. The reported data are for the first 28 days after a post’s publication and include both desktop and mobile Facebook use. “Engaged users” refers to the number of people who have clicked anywhere on a particular post. “Talked about” refers to the number of people who have created a story from a particular post. Stories include

From Columbia University College of Physicians and Surgeons, New York^a; Department of Dermatology, University of Colorado Denver, Aurora^b; Department of Epidemiology, Colorado School of Public Health, Aurora^c; and Dermatology Service, Department of Veterans Affairs Medical Center, Denver.^d

Funding sources: None.

Conflicts of interest: None declared.

Reprint requests: Robert P. Dellavalle, MD, PhD, MSPH, Dermatology Service, Department of Veterans Affairs Medical

Center, 1055 Clermont St, Box 165, Denver, CO 80220. E-mail: robert.dellavalle@ucdenver.edu.

J Am Acad Dermatol 2014;70:377-9.

0190-9622

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<http://dx.doi.org/10.1016/j.jaad.2013.10.050>

Table II. Top-5 posts with the largest reach

Title of post	Type of post	Date posted	Reach
Britney Spears reveals skin condition: She has psoriasis	<i>Hollywood Life</i> news story	July 21, 2013	4592
Yes! 9 celebs who look better without the tan	<i>Daily Makeover</i> news story	May 27, 2013	3058
The women becoming immune to Botox: How overuse of the wrinkle-freezing drug is changing	<i>Daily Mail</i> news story	July 18, 2013	2680
An aspirin a day helps keep melanoma away? Whether it is worth the increased risk of gastrointestinal bleeding may be a personal risk decision	<i>CNN Health</i> blog news story	March 11, 2013	2696
Bras make breasts saggy: 15-year French study	<i>Counsel and Heal</i> news story	April 12, 2013	2501

"Reach" is number of people who have seen a particular post (figures are for the first 28 days after a post's publication).

Table III. Top-5 posts with the most engaged users

Title of post	Type of post	Date posted	Engaged users
Hailey-Hailey disease	<i>UpToDate</i> photograph	February 18, 2013	575
Vulvar inflammatory bowel disease	<i>JAMA</i> photograph	June 29, 2013	515
What type of dermatitis...? (periorificial)	<i>UpToDate</i> photograph	February 6, 2013	436
Henna contact dermatitis	<i>Dermatology News Daily</i> photograph	May 31, 2013	406
Britney Spears reveals skin condition: She has psoriasis	<i>Hollywood Life</i> news story	July 21, 2013	389

"Engaged users" refers to number of people who have clicked anywhere on post.

Table IV. Top-5 posts with most readers talking about them

Title of post	Type of post	Date posted	Users talking
Henna contact dermatitis	<i>Dermatology News Daily</i> photograph	May 31, 2013	138
An aspirin a day helps keep melanoma away? Whether it is worth the increased risk of gastrointestinal bleeding may be a personal risk decision	<i>CNN Health</i> blog news story	March 11, 2013	130
Lots of bad in lipsticks!	<i>USA Today</i> article	May 2, 2013	126
Yes! 9 celebs who look better without the tan	<i>Daily Makeover</i> article	May 27, 2013	98
Britney Spears reveals skin condition: She has psoriasis	<i>Hollywood Life</i> news story	July 21, 2013	93

"Talking about" is number of people who have created a story from page post; stories include: (1) sharing, "Liking," or commenting on post; (2) answering a question; (3) responding to an event; and (4) claiming an offer.

sharing, "Liking," or commenting on the post; answering a question; responding to an event; or claiming an offer.⁷

The demographics of users who "Liked" the *JAAD* Facebook page demonstrate a surprisingly diverse population of users, with only 18% coming from the United States, 17% from Brazil, and 14% from Egypt. Accordingly, English was the most common spoken language of users with Portuguese, Spanish, and Arabic following in decreasing frequency. In addition, roughly two thirds of *JAAD* users are women, a statistic that is almost identical to the 64% of women who use Facebook (Table I).⁸

Valuable and fascinating discoveries were also made from analysis of post data. The top-5 posts with the largest reach all came from news stories: 2

regarding celebrities, 2 involving preventative measures for aging and melanoma, and 1 post presenting a paradoxical study regarding bra use (Table II). However, engaging users to click anywhere on a post requires a different post type. The top 4 of 5 posts with the most engaged users were photographs coming from sources including *UpToDate*, *JAMA*, and *Dermatology News Daily*. The fifth post again involved celebrity news (Table III). There has been much interest regarding the success of photo posts on Facebook. Photo posts receive more engagement than links, videos, and text-based updates; and comprise 93% of the most engaging posts on Facebook.⁹ This is supported by the presented analysis for the *JAAD*'s Facebook page. Finally, the top-5 posts with the

most users talking about them covered a wider variety of post types including an eye-catching photograph, melanoma prevention, cosmetics, and celebrity news (Table IV). A post that appeared in the top 5 of the reach, engaged users, and talked about categories was *Hollywood Life's* report entitled, "Britney Spears reveals skin condition: She has psoriasis." By visiting the individual profiles of each of the 28 users who "Liked" this post, 54% (15 of 28) categorized their profession as medical doctor or listed a workplace associated with dermatology, skin care, or cosmetic companies.

Over the span of 2 months (June 13 to August 13, 2013), the *JAAD* Facebook page acquired 522 new unique user "Likes" with an average of 10 new "Likes" per day. During its peak month, a post from the *JAAD* Facebook page was displayed in some format 265,355 times, including whether it was clicked on or not and multiple impressions of the same post.⁶ This is almost 200% greater than the *JAAD's* World Wide Web site (www.jaad.org), which reports 134,664 monthly page views.¹⁰ The impact of a social networking site such as Facebook on a journal's ability to reach populations across the globe is astounding. Even so, the number of users who "Like" the *JAAD* Facebook page make up only 0.00044% of all Facebook users.^{1,6} The *JAAD* in print is distributed to more than 16,000 dermatologists and is predominantly directed toward the medical community.¹⁰ Our data suggest that 54% of users who "Liked" a *JAAD* Facebook post that was in the top 5 in each category (reach, engaged users, and talked about) are medical doctors or are associated with skin care—related companies. Perhaps the other 46% of users represent a larger public outreach to those not necessarily within the medical community. The ability to reach a wider audience is a significant advantage of social media. However, a major limitation of our analysis is that Facebook privacy settings and individual preferences limit what the public can view on a person's Facebook profile. Many users choose not to make their education and work accessible to the public. Thus, we may have missed users in the 46% who are indeed dermatologists or associated with the skin care community.

Some suggestions to further enhance the interactive educational opportunity afforded by the *JAAD's*

Facebook page may include adding the following posts: (1) quizzes using photographs in the print version of the journal, (2) blogs that highlight practice gaps or other topics of concern, and (3) author podcasts discussing how authors became interested in their research and summarizing their *JAAD* article findings. The rapidly expanding reach of the *JAAD's* Facebook page continues to present a unique opportunity to connect with the global dermatologic community and public to improve public information on skin disease.¹¹ Many thanks to those who keep "Liking" it on Facebook!

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